

PTI

3. IF YOU GET A NOTICE

WHY IT HAPPENED

- Unmapped to previous SIR rolls
- Logical discrepancy (unusual age gap with parent/ grandparent, spelling mismatch, etc.)
- Third-party objection to your inclusion

WHAT TO DO

- A notice does not automatically mean deletion
- Field verification may follow, particularly in unmapped or discrepancy cases
- Hearings may be held—online, where feasible
- The ERO takes the final decision

WHAT PROOF MAY BE REQUIRED

Born in India before Jul. 1, 1987: Your document establishing date/ place of birth

Born Jul. 1, 1987–Dec. 2, 2004: Your document + either parent's document

Born after Dec. 2, 2004: Your document + both parents' documents, where applicable

Documents (indicative): ● Birth certificate ● Passport ● School/ university certificate ● Govt land/ house allotment records ● Govt employ/ pension records ● Caste certificate ● Permanent residence certificate ● Govt-maintained family registers ● NRC records, where available ● Aadhaar, subject to ECI's directions (it establishes identity, not citizenship)

4. FINAL ROLL

After claims, objections and verification are completed, the final roll is published. Check your name again, even if it appeared in the draft

STILL MISSING Apply afresh through Form 6

AGGRIEVED BY ERO'S DECISION
Appeal to the district-level authority and Chief Electoral Officer of the state

Parliament legislated within months. The 2023 law replaced the CJI with a Union Cabinet minister nominated by the prime minister, giving the government two representatives on the three-member selection panel, alongside the leader of the Opposition. A search committee headed by the law minister draws up the shortlist, while eligibility is restricted to those who have held posts equivalent to secretary to the Government of India, effectively limiting the field to serving or retired bureaucrats. A provision in the original bill that would have placed the commissioners' pay and status on a par with the cabinet secretary rather than a Supreme Court judge was dropped following protests. Security of tenure remains uneven. Under Article 324(5), the CEC can be removed only in the same manner and on the same grounds as a Supreme Court judge, while an EC can be removed on the CEC's recommendation.

The new law was tested almost at once. In March 2024, Kumar and Sandhu were appointed days after Goel resigned; Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury, the Opposition member on the panel, said the shortlist reached him only minutes before the meeting. The Supreme Court declined to stay the appointments ahead of the Lok Sabha election but not before questioning the undue haste. In February 2025, Kumar was elevated as CEC the same night the selection committee met, over a written



"The SIR exercise is conceptually flawed. It turns the system upside down by shifting the burden of proving eligibility from the Election Commission to the voter"

—ASHOK LAVASA
Former Election Commissioner

dissent from Rahul Gandhi. The challenge to the law remains unresolved. The controversy has brought into focus not just who appoints ECs, but also how much institutional independence the system gives them once they are appointed.

A government-controlled selection process and unequal protection make dissent inside the ECI rare and costly. History offers examples. In 2009, CEC N. Gopalaswami recommended the removal of EC Navin Chawla over allegations of partisan conduct; the recommendation was rejected and Chawla later became CEC. In 2019, EC Ashok Lavasa dissented from the ECI's decisions on Model Code complaints involving Narendra Modi and Amit Shah. He resigned in August 2020, despite being next in line to become CEC. Goel resigned in March 2024, days before the Lok Sabha election schedule was announced, without giving a public reason. The irony of the present crisis is that both dissenters, Sandhu and Joshi, were appointed under the 2023 law. It is a reminder that the problem is less the individuals than a system that leaves neutrality to the office-bearers' conscience.